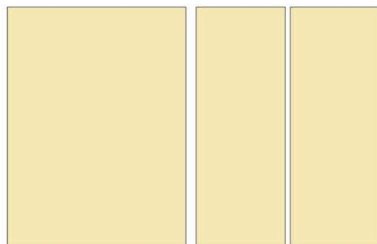


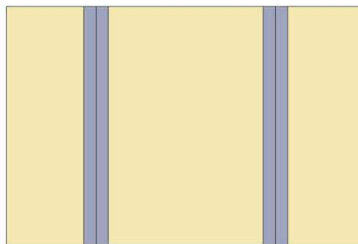
▶▶ MAKING A BIGGER BACKING

Most bed quilts are wider than most fabrics, so it is often necessary to piece the backing. There are several



1 Cut two full widths of fabric of the required length. Set one aside, and cut the other in half lengthways. Trim off all selvages.

ways to do this, but you should avoid having a seam down the vertical centre of the quilt.



2 Add one half-width to each vertical side of the full width to get the required width.

▶▶ BAGGING OUT

Sometimes you may want to finish the edges of the quilt before you quilt it. The technique works well on smaller

projects, such as baby quilts. Cut the wadding and backing slightly larger than the quilt top.



1 Centre the quilt top right-side up on the wadding. Centre the backing on the quilt top, right side down. Pin or tack the layers together around the edge.

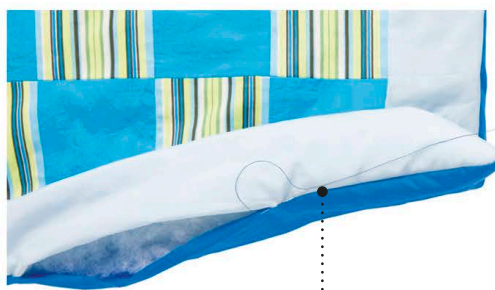
2 Start machine stitching at the bottom edge, several centimetres (about an inch) from the corner, taking a 6mm ($\frac{1}{4}$ in) seam. Secure with backstitching.



3 At the corners, stop 6mm ($\frac{1}{4}$ in) from the edge with the needle down. Raise the presser foot. Pivot the fabric, lower the presser foot and continue sewing. On the fourth side leave an opening of 12–25cm (5–10in). Secure with backstitching.



4 Clip the corners to reduce bulk. If necessary, trim and grade the seams, then turn right side out through the opening.



5 Level the edges on the inside. Pin or press lightly. Blind stitch the opening closed.